

▲ BROWNING M2 HB

Date 1933

Origin US

Weight 38.1kg (84lb)

Barrel 1.14m (3¾ft)

Calibre .5in

The highly effective “fifty cal” M2 HB (heavy barrel) has been used as key armament in aircraft, on armoured vehicles, and by ground troops. It remains in service even today.



Spade grips

Ammunition belt supporting box

▼ MG34

Date 1935

Origin Germany

Weight 11.5kg (25¼lb)

Barrel 62.7cm (24¾in)

Calibre 7.92 × 57mm

The MG34 was a revolutionary design – light, yet robust enough to deliver sustained fire at 900 rounds per minute. However, it was difficult and expensive to manufacture and was subsequently replaced by the MG42.



Flash suppressor

Ammunition belt feed

Barrel jacket



▼ BREN GUN

Date 1938

Origin UK

Weight 10.15kg (22¼lb)

Barrel 63.5cm (25in)

Calibre .303in

Originally developed in Brno, Czechoslovakia, and modified at Enfield in London (hence its name), the dependable Bren was the British Army's light machine-gun during World War II, and remained in service until the 1980s.



Rear sight

Left-hand grip

30-round detachable box magazine

Cocking handle

Gas cylinder

Adjustable gas regulator

Tripod attachment point

▼ DEGTYAREV DSHK1938

Date 1938

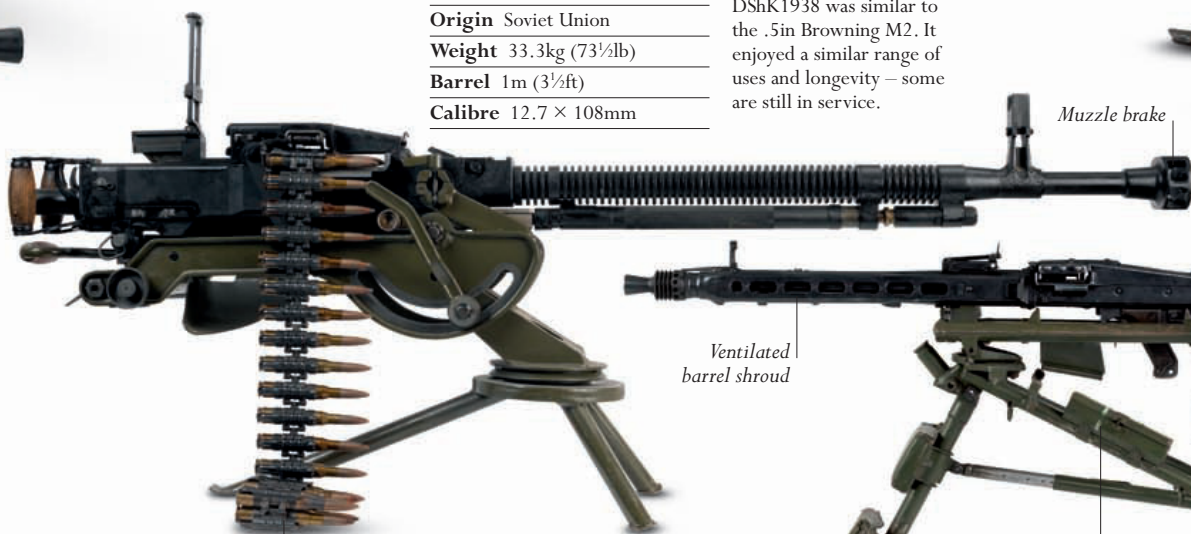
Origin Soviet Union

Weight 33.3kg (73½lb)

Barrel 1m (3½ft)

Calibre 12.7 × 108mm

Employed as the Red Army's heavy machine-gun, the DShK1938 was similar to the .5in Browning M2. It enjoyed a similar range of uses and longevity – some are still in service.



Muzzle brake

Ventilated barrel shroud

Non-disintegrating steel ammunition belt

◀ MG42

Date 1942

Origin Germany

Weight 11.5kg (25¼lb)

Barrel 53.3cm (21in)

Calibre 7.92 × 57mm

A successor to the MG34, the MG42 had an extraordinarily high rate of fire – over 1,200 rounds per minute – and, when used with a tripod, was capable of sustained long-range fire.



Pad for ease of carrying

Lafette 42 heavy tripod